Guardrails: rules around the model

AI security · Level 2 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Describe three kinds of guardrail around an AI model.
- Explain why word lists miss rewording and block innocent text.
- Explain why a check on the action holds.

Remember

- Guardrails are rules around the model: in, out and action.
- Word lists miss rewording and stop the innocent.
- Check the action, allow rather than just ban, and stack layers.

The word-list robot

1. Warm-up (5 min): How does the school gate decide who comes in?
2. Teach (8 min): Three guardrails; why word lists miss.
3. Round 1 (12 min): The robot blocks banned words; classmates reword.
4. Round 2 (10 min): The teacher approves every slip; compare.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which rule held, and why? Exit ticket.

The messages ask only for homework answers, nothing harmful. Watch for innocent slips the robot stops: they are the false alarms worth discussing.

Let’s discuss

1. Why did reworded messages get past the robot?
2. Which innocent message did the robot stop?
3. Why did the teacher's yes work whatever the wording?

Exit ticket

- Write one weakness of a word filter, and one guardrail that holds whatever the wording.